

The 4-Phase AI Adoption Framework

Generative AI for Business Leaders & C-Suite | AI Implementation Strategy

1. The Implementation Mindset Shift

Most executives approach AI adoption the way they approach enterprise software rollouts: build a detailed requirements document, evaluate vendors for six months, run a carefully controlled pilot, seek consensus from every stakeholder, then roll out in a phased multi-year plan. This approach made sense for ERP systems and CRM platforms. It is catastrophically wrong for AI.

AI adoption rewards speed and iteration over perfection and planning. The technology evolves so rapidly that a strategy painstakingly crafted over six months may be obsolete before implementation begins. The models you evaluated in January may be two generations behind by July. The use cases your team identified may have been automated by a platform update you did not anticipate. Speed is not recklessness here; it is risk management. The longer you wait, the more your competitors learn, the wider the capability gap grows, and the harder it becomes to catch up.

Think of AI adoption less like installing a new system and more like learning a language. You do not become fluent by studying grammar textbooks for a year. You become fluent by immersing yourself in conversation, making mistakes, and building intuition through practice. Your organisation needs to build AI intuition, and that only comes from hands-on experience at every level.

Key Point: The biggest predictor of AI adoption failure is not choosing the wrong technology. It is spending too long choosing. Organisations that move from decision to first pilot in under four weeks consistently outperform those that spend months planning. Analysis paralysis is the silent killer of AI transformation.

2. Why Most AI Initiatives Fail

Before understanding how the 4-Phase Framework succeeds, it is essential to understand the failure modes it is designed to prevent. Research from Boston Consulting Group (2023) found that approximately 70% of corporate AI pilots never progress beyond the pilot stage. They become trapped in what practitioners call 'pilot purgatory' -- endlessly tested, never scaled, and eventually abandoned when budget cycles change or executive sponsors move on.

Failure Mode	What Happens	How the 4-Phase Framework Prevents It
Starting too big	Teams attempt to transform an entire business function at once. Complexity overwhelms resources, timelines slip, and results are diluted.	Phase 2 limits pilots to 3-5 focused projects with 3-5 person teams and 4-week timelines.
Lack of executive sponsorship	AI is treated as an IT experiment rather than a strategic initiative. Middle managers lack authority to overcome resistance.	Phase 1 begins with an executive announcement and leadership training, establishing top-down

		commitment.
Technology-first thinking	Teams select tools before identifying business problems. Expensive platforms are purchased and underutilised.	Phase 1 starts with department exploration sessions to identify pain points before any tool selection.
No measurable outcomes	Pilots produce subjective feedback ('team likes it') but no quantifiable ROI, making it impossible to justify scaling.	Phase 2 requires every pilot to have defined success metrics before launch.
Ignoring change management	Leaders assume employees will naturally adopt AI. Instead, fear, skepticism, and inertia create passive resistance.	Phase 1 includes hands-on training. Phase 4 embeds AI into onboarding and standard operating procedures.

Real-World Incident -- GE's Digital Transformation (2015-2018): General Electric invested over \$4 billion in its Predix industrial IoT platform, attempting to transform the entire company into a 'digital industrial' organisation simultaneously. The initiative was too broad, lacked clear success metrics for individual business units, and failed to secure buy-in from operational leaders who saw it as corporate overhead rather than a tool for their teams. By 2018, GE had written off the majority of its digital investment and spun off the division. The lesson: even companies with unlimited budgets cannot succeed by attempting everything at once.

3. Phase 1 -- Education and Exploration (Weeks 1-2)

Phase 1 is not a planning phase. It is an activation phase. The goal is to move your entire leadership team from abstract awareness of AI to concrete understanding of what it can do for their specific departments. This happens through two simultaneous tracks.

Week 1: Leadership Activation

The initiative launches with an executive announcement. This is not a memo or a Slack message. It is a visible, public commitment from the CEO or equivalent. The announcement should communicate three things: why AI matters to the organisation's future, that every department will participate, and that experimentation is not just permitted but expected. Immediately following the announcement, leadership undergoes a half-day hands-on AI training session. This is not a vendor demo or a slide presentation. Leaders sit at laptops and use AI tools on real work tasks. They draft a strategy memo with ChatGPT. They summarise a contract with Claude. They generate a marketing concept with Midjourney. The experience of personally using AI is transformative in a way that no presentation can replicate. By the end of the session, executives understand AI's capabilities viscerally, not theoretically.

Week 2: Department Discovery and Prioritisation

Each department runs a two-hour exploration session where team members identify tasks that consume significant time and could benefit from AI. The output is a ranked list of opportunities evaluated against four criteria: frequency of the task, measurability of improvement, risk tolerance for errors, and cross-functional applicability. Leadership then selects 3-5 pilot projects that score highest across these criteria.

The selection should include representation from at least two different departments to build cross-functional momentum.

4. Phase 2 -- Pilot Projects (Weeks 3-6)

Phase 2 converts promising ideas into measured experiments. Each pilot operates as a small, autonomous unit with a clear mandate and a hard deadline.

Pilot Element	Requirement	Why It Matters
Team size	3-5 people maximum	Small teams move faster, communicate better, and make decisions without committee delays.
Dedicated owner	One named individual with authority to make daily decisions	Committees slow pilots to a crawl. A single owner ensures momentum.
Success metrics	2-3 quantifiable KPIs defined before launch	Without pre-defined metrics, teams cannot prove value and scaling decisions become political.
Timeline	4 weeks from setup to results presentation	Hard deadlines force focus and prevent scope creep. 4 weeks is enough to prove a concept.
Tool budget	Pre-approved spending authority for AI tools	Teams that need procurement approval for a \$50/month tool lose weeks to bureaucracy.

The weekly rhythm during Phase 2 is deliberate. Week 3 focuses on tool selection and initial setup. Week 4 is the first full week of execution where teams use AI on real tasks and document results daily. Week 5 continues execution with refinements based on Week 4 learnings. Week 6 is dedicated to results documentation, including a brief presentation showing what worked, what failed, quantified results, and a recommendation on whether to scale, refine, or stop.

5. Phase 3 -- Scale Winners (Weeks 7-10)

Phase 3 is where most organisations falter, not because scaling is technically difficult, but because organisational inertia reasserts itself. The transition from 'interesting pilot' to 'standard practice' requires deliberate action.

The scaling decision is binary and data-driven. If a pilot met or exceeded its success metrics, it scales to all relevant departments immediately. If it fell short, it either receives one more two-week iteration with adjusted parameters or it is shelved without guilt. There is no middle ground. 'Promising but needs more data' is a phrase that kills AI programs.

Scaling means replicating the pilot's workflow, prompts, and tools across every team that does similar work. If customer service AI worked in the European support team, it rolls out to North America, Asia, and Latin America in the same week. If content creation AI delivered results in marketing, it is offered to sales enablement, HR communications, and internal communications simultaneously. Speed matters because each successful team becomes an advocate and trainer for the next wave.

6. Phase 4 -- Organisation-Wide Rollout (Weeks 11-12+)

Phase 4 marks the transition from AI as a project to AI as infrastructure. At this stage, AI is no longer something your company is experimenting with. It is something your company runs on.

- **Onboarding integration:** Every new employee receives AI tool training as part of their first-week orientation, just as they receive email setup and security training.
- **SOP embedding:** Standard operating procedures are updated to include AI-assisted steps. The procedure for writing a client proposal now includes 'Generate first draft using [AI tool] with [standard prompt]' as Step 1.
- **Governance framework:** Clear policies define what AI can and cannot be used for, data handling rules, review requirements for AI-generated outputs, and escalation procedures for edge cases.
- **Continuous improvement:** Monthly reviews of AI tool usage, new feature adoption, and emerging use cases ensure the organisation evolves as fast as the technology.
- **Training cadence:** Quarterly skill-building sessions keep teams current as AI capabilities expand. What was impossible six months ago may now be routine.

7. Timeline Comparison -- Traditional vs. 4-Phase Approach

Activity	Traditional Approach	4-Phase Framework
Leadership alignment	2-3 months of strategy development and board presentations	1 week: executive announcement + hands-on training
Use case identification	3-6 months of consulting engagements and assessment reports	1 week: department exploration sessions
First pilot launch	Month 6-9 after extensive requirements and vendor evaluation	Week 3: pilots begin with pre-approved tools
First measurable results	Month 12-18	Week 6: results presentations with quantified ROI
Scaled deployment	Month 18-24 (if pilots survive budget cycles)	Weeks 7-10: winners roll out organisation-wide
Full integration	Year 3+ (often never)	Week 12: AI embedded in operations and onboarding

The difference is stark. Organisations using the 4-Phase Framework achieve in 90 days what traditional approaches take 18-36 months to accomplish. In a technology landscape where six months of delay can mean permanent competitive disadvantage, this acceleration is not just convenient. It is existential.

8. Overcoming Common Objections to Rapid Adoption

Every organisation faces internal resistance when attempting to move at this pace. Understanding the most common objections and preparing responses is critical for maintaining momentum.

'We need more time to evaluate options'

This is the most dangerous objection because it sounds reasonable. The counter is simple: evaluation without experimentation is guesswork. A team that uses three AI tools for two weeks learns more than a

committee that reads vendor whitepapers for six months. The 4-Phase Framework does not skip evaluation; it compresses it by making evaluation hands-on and concurrent with pilot execution.

'What about data security and compliance?'

This is a legitimate concern that must be addressed early, not used as a reason to delay. Enterprise AI tools like ChatGPT Enterprise, Claude for Business, and Microsoft Copilot offer enterprise-grade security, data isolation, and compliance certifications. Most security teams can evaluate and approve these tools in one to two weeks. Run the security review in parallel with Phase 1 training so it does not become a sequential blocker.

'Our industry is different / too regulated'

Every industry believes it is uniquely complex. In reality, even heavily regulated industries such as healthcare (Moderna), financial services (Morgan Stanley), and government agencies have adopted AI rapidly. The 4-Phase Framework accounts for regulation by starting with low-risk internal use cases that do not trigger compliance concerns, then expanding as governance frameworks mature.

9. Measuring Framework Success

The framework itself should be measured against five outcome benchmarks at the 90-day mark:

Outcome	Target	How to Measure
Leadership AI literacy	100% of senior leaders have used AI on real work	Survey + tool usage logs
Pilot completion rate	At least 3 of 5 pilots produce quantified results	Phase 2 results presentations
Scaling velocity	Winning pilots deployed to all relevant teams within 4 weeks	Deployment tracking dashboard
Employee adoption	50%+ of target employees using AI tools weekly	Tool usage analytics
Measurable ROI	At least one use case delivers provable cost savings or revenue impact	Finance-validated metrics

10. Building Your 90-Day Calendar

Transform the framework into a concrete weekly calendar by assigning specific activities to each week. This is not a suggestion to plan later. Block the time now. AI adoption that is not on the calendar does not happen.

- **Week 1:** CEO announcement. Leadership half-day training. Security review initiated.
- **Week 2:** Department exploration sessions. Opportunity prioritisation. Pilot projects selected.
- **Week 3:** Pilot teams formed. Tools provisioned. Success metrics locked. Kick-off meetings held.
- **Weeks 4-5:** Active pilot execution. Daily check-ins within teams. Weekly cross-team sharing.
- **Week 6:** Pilot results documented. Presentations to leadership. Scale/stop decisions made.
- **Weeks 7-10:** Winning pilots rolled out across departments. New teams trained by pilot teams.

- **Weeks 11-12:** SOPs updated. Onboarding modified. Governance policies published. Continuous improvement cadence established.

11. Key Terms Glossary

Term	Definition
Pilot purgatory	The state where AI projects remain in indefinite testing, never scaling to production use because organisations cannot commit to scaling decisions.
Executive sponsorship	Active, visible support from a C-level leader who commits authority, budget, and public advocacy to the initiative.
Change management	The structured approach to transitioning individuals, teams, and organisations from current processes to new AI-enabled workflows.
Quick win	A pilot project that delivers measurable results with minimal risk, building organisational confidence for larger initiatives.
Governance framework	The policies, procedures, and oversight structures that define how AI tools may be used, what data they may access, and how outputs are reviewed.
SOP (Standard Operating Procedure)	A documented set of step-by-step instructions for routine operations, updated in Phase 4 to include AI-assisted steps.
ROI (Return on Investment)	The ratio of net benefit to cost, used to quantify the business value of AI pilots and justify scaling decisions.
Cross-functional pilot	A pilot project that involves participants from multiple departments, building broader organisational buy-in and diverse learning.

12. Quick Revision Checklist

- The 4-Phase Framework compresses typical 18-36 month AI adoption into 90 days through action-biased execution.
- Phase 1 (Weeks 1-2): Education and exploration -- executive announcement, leadership training, department discovery sessions.
- Phase 2 (Weeks 3-6): Pilot projects -- 3-5 focused pilots with dedicated owners, defined metrics, and 4-week deadlines.
- Phase 3 (Weeks 7-10): Scale winners -- binary scale/stop decisions based on data, not consensus.
- Phase 4 (Weeks 11-12+): Organisation-wide rollout -- AI embedded in onboarding, SOPs, and governance.
- 70% of corporate AI pilots never progress beyond pilot stage (BCG, 2023).
- The five failure modes: starting too big, no executive sponsorship, technology-first thinking, no measurable outcomes, ignoring change management.
- Pilot teams should be 3-5 people with a single named owner and pre-approved tool budgets.
- Speed is risk management in AI adoption -- delayed action increases competitive gap.
- The framework should be measured against five outcome benchmarks at the 90-day mark.

20 Exam-Based MCQs — AI Adoption Framework

Test yourself after reading. These questions are written in real exam style — scenario-heavy, with plausible distractors. Read every explanation, including for questions you answered correctly.

Q1. What is the primary purpose of Phase 1 in the 4-Phase AI Adoption Framework?

- A) Select and purchase AI technology platforms
- B) Build awareness, train leadership, and identify opportunities through hands-on experience
- C) Deploy AI across the entire organisation simultaneously
- D) Develop a comprehensive 12-month AI strategy document

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because Phase 1 (Weeks 1-2) focuses on education and exploration: executive announcement, half-day leadership training with hands-on AI use, and department exploration sessions to identify opportunities. A is wrong because tool selection happens in Phase 2 during pilot setup, not Phase 1. C is wrong because organisation-wide deployment is Phase 4, not Phase 1. D is wrong because the framework deliberately avoids lengthy strategy development in favour of rapid action.

Q2. *Scenario:* A mid-sized logistics company has decided to adopt AI. The CTO suggests spending six months evaluating vendors, three months building a detailed business case, and then launching a single large-scale pilot across the entire supply chain operation. Based on the 4-Phase Framework, what is the MOST significant risk with this approach?

- A) The pilot team will be too large to manage effectively
- B) The 9-month planning phase will cause the company to fall behind competitors who move faster, and the single large pilot increases the risk of total failure
- C) The CTO should not be leading the initiative
- D) Six months is not enough time for proper vendor evaluation

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the framework emphasises that speed is risk management - a 9-month planning cycle means the company acts on stale information while competitors build capability, and concentrating resources in a single large pilot creates binary risk (total success or total failure) rather than the portfolio approach of 3-5 small pilots. A identifies a real but secondary issue. C is irrelevant to the framework's guidance on timeline and scope. D contradicts the framework's principle that hands-on evaluation during pilots is superior to extended paper-based evaluation.

Q3. According to research cited in the lecture, what percentage of corporate AI pilots fail to progress beyond the pilot stage?

- A) 30%
- B) 50%
- C) 70%
- D) 90%

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct -- Boston Consulting Group (2023) found that approximately 70% of corporate AI pilots never progress beyond the pilot stage, a phenomenon known as 'pilot purgatory'. A

(30%) and B (50%) understate the severity. D (90%) overstates it.

Q4. Scenario: During Week 2 of Phase 1, a department exploration session at a financial services firm identifies 40 potential AI use cases. The VP of Operations wants to select 15 pilot projects to maximise learning across the organisation. The CIO recommends limiting selection to 4 pilots. Whose recommendation BEST aligns with the 4-Phase Framework, and why?

- A) The VP's, because more pilots mean faster learning and broader organisational engagement
- B) The CIO's, because the framework recommends 3-5 pilot projects with dedicated owners and defined metrics to ensure quality execution
- C) Neither -- all 40 use cases should be piloted simultaneously
- D) Neither -- the company should hire a consulting firm to evaluate all 40 use cases before selecting any

Answer: B Explanation: B is correct because the framework explicitly recommends 3-5 pilot projects, each with a dedicated owner, a small team of 3-5 people, and specific success metrics. Quality of execution matters more than quantity. A is wrong because 15 pilots would stretch resources thin, dilute focus, and make it impossible to provide adequate support and measurement for each. C is impractical and contradicts the framework's emphasis on focused effort. D introduces the kind of delay and analysis paralysis the framework is designed to prevent.

Q5. In Phase 2, what is the recommended team size for each pilot project?

- A) 1-2 people to minimise cost
- B) 3-5 people with a dedicated owner
- C) 10-15 people for cross-functional representation
- D) The entire department to ensure buy-in

Answer: B Explanation: B is correct -- the framework specifies 3-5 people per pilot with a single dedicated owner who has authority to make daily decisions. A is too small to execute a meaningful pilot. C and D are too large, which introduces coordination overhead, slows decision-making, and dilutes accountability.

Q6. Scenario: A retail company completes Phase 2 with five pilot projects. Three pilots exceeded their success metrics. One pilot showed marginal improvement (5% efficiency gain versus the 20% target). One pilot failed to produce measurable results. The head of digital suggests giving the marginal pilot another eight weeks to 'reach its potential'. What decision BEST aligns with the Phase 3 scaling principles?

- A) Scale all five pilots to give every team a fair chance
- B) Scale the three successful pilots immediately, give the marginal pilot one more two-week iteration with adjusted parameters, and shelve the failed pilot
- C) Scale only the single most successful pilot to concentrate resources
- D) Pause all pilots and commission a comprehensive analysis of why two underperformed

Answer: B Explanation: B is correct because Phase 3 prescribes binary, data-driven decisions: successful

pilots scale immediately, borderline pilots receive one more short iteration (not eight weeks), and failed pilots are shelved without guilt. A ignores the data-driven scaling principle by including a failed pilot. C is too conservative and wastes the momentum of three proven successes. D introduces analysis paralysis and delays scaling of proven winners.

Q7. What does the framework identify as the 'silent killer' of AI transformation?

- A) Insufficient budget allocation
- B) Analysis paralysis -- spending too long choosing before acting
- C) Employee resistance to new technology
- D) Lack of technical AI expertise

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct -- the framework explicitly identifies analysis paralysis as the silent killer, noting that organisations spending too long choosing consistently underperform those that move from decision to first pilot in under four weeks. A is rarely the actual constraint for AI tools that cost \$20-60 per user per month. C is a real challenge but is addressed through the framework's change management components, not identified as the primary killer. D is less relevant given modern AI tools that require no programming expertise.

Q8. *Scenario:* A healthcare company is considering AI adoption. The Chief Compliance Officer argues that their industry is 'too regulated' for the 90-day framework and proposes a 24-month phased approach with regulatory review at every stage. What is the BEST response based on the framework's guidance?

- A) Accept the 24-month timeline because healthcare regulation genuinely requires extended review periods
- B) Acknowledge the compliance concern, run security review in parallel with Phase 1 training, and start with low-risk internal use cases that do not trigger compliance issues
- C) Skip the compliance review entirely to maintain the 90-day timeline
- D) Outsource the AI implementation to a vendor that specialises in regulated industries

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the framework addresses this exact objection: even heavily regulated industries (Moderna in biotech, Morgan Stanley in financial services) have adopted AI rapidly by starting with low-risk internal use cases and running security reviews in parallel rather than sequentially. A accepts a timeline that creates competitive disadvantage. C is reckless and would create genuine regulatory risk. D does not address the underlying objection and introduces vendor dependency.

Q9. Which of the following is included in Phase 4 of the framework?

- A) Selecting pilot projects for initial testing
- B) Conducting leadership hands-on AI training
- C) Embedding AI into new employee onboarding, updating SOPs, and establishing governance policies
- D) Evaluating AI vendor proposals

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct -- Phase 4 (Weeks 11-12+) focuses on making AI standard practice by

embedding it in onboarding, integrating it into SOPs, establishing governance frameworks, creating ongoing training programmes, and building continuous improvement processes. A belongs to Phase 1. B belongs to Phase 1. D is not a discrete phase activity; tool selection happens during Phase 2 pilot setup.

Q10. Scenario: After completing the 4-Phase Framework, a manufacturing company measures its outcomes at the 90-day mark. They find that 80% of senior leaders have used AI on real work, 2 of 5 pilots produced quantified results, and 30% of target employees are using AI tools weekly. Based on the framework's success benchmarks, which outcome is MOST concerning?

- A) 80% leadership AI literacy (target: 100%)
- B) 2 of 5 pilots with quantified results (target: at least 3 of 5)
- C) 30% employee adoption (target: 50%+)
- D) All three are equally concerning

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct and most concerning because pilot completion rate directly determines what can be scaled in Phase 3 -- with only 2 successful pilots, the organisation has fewer proven use cases to scale, which limits momentum and delays organisation-wide adoption. A is a gap but leadership can be addressed with follow-up sessions. C (employee adoption) is partly a consequence of B -- fewer scaled pilots means fewer employees have access to proven AI workflows. D incorrectly treats all gaps as equal when the pilot completion rate has the strongest cascading effect.

Q11. What is 'pilot purgatory' in the context of AI adoption?

- A) A phase where pilots run too quickly without adequate testing
- B) The state where AI projects remain in indefinite testing, never scaling to production use
- C) A period where too many pilots compete for limited resources
- D) The time between vendor selection and contract signing

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct -- pilot purgatory describes AI projects that are endlessly tested but never progress to scaled deployment, often because organisations lack clear scaling criteria, executive commitment, or the willingness to make binary scale/stop decisions. A describes the opposite problem. C describes resource contention, not the scaling failure. D describes procurement delays, which is unrelated.

Q12. Scenario: A technology company is in Week 3 of Phase 2. One pilot team wants to use an AI tool that costs \$40 per user per month, but their purchase request has been stuck in procurement for two weeks waiting for three levels of approval. What does this situation indicate about the company's framework implementation?

- A) The procurement process is working correctly to protect the company from unnecessary spending
- B) The pilot lacks the pre-approved spending authority that the framework requires, creating bureaucratic delays that undermine pilot velocity
- C) The pilot team should use free AI tools instead to avoid procurement entirely
- D) The pilot should be paused until procurement is resolved

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the framework explicitly requires pre-approved spending authority for AI tools as part of pilot setup. A \$40/month tool held up for two weeks by procurement represents exactly the kind of bureaucratic friction that kills pilot momentum. A misidentifies unnecessary friction as appropriate governance. C might work as a workaround but does not address the structural problem. D would waste the pilot's fixed 4-week execution window.

Q13. According to the framework, what is the recommended approach to AI adoption compared to traditional enterprise software rollouts?

- A) Use the same phased, consensus-driven approach used for ERP and CRM systems
- B) Prioritise speed and iteration over perfection and planning, treating AI adoption more like learning a language than installing software
- C) Skip all planning and immediately deploy AI tools to every employee
- D) Focus exclusively on technology evaluation before any organisational changes

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct -- the framework explicitly contrasts AI adoption with traditional software rollouts, arguing that AI rewards speed and iteration because the technology evolves rapidly and organisational AI intuition only develops through hands-on experience. A applies the wrong mental model. C is reckless and skips the essential education and exploration phase. D is technology-first thinking, one of the five identified failure modes.

Q14. *Scenario:* A consumer goods company completes Phase 1. Department exploration sessions identify that their legal team spends 60% of their time reviewing standard contracts, their marketing team needs more content variations, and their finance team manually reconciles reports across three systems daily. Which use case should be prioritised FIRST for a Phase 2 pilot?

- A) Legal contract review, because it consumes the most time
- B) Finance report reconciliation, because it is done daily, is measurable, and errors are easily caught by human review
- C) Marketing content generation, because it has the most creative potential
- D) All three should be launched as a single integrated pilot

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because finance report reconciliation best matches the prioritisation criteria: high frequency (daily), clearly measurable (time saved, error rate), and low risk (humans review AI output before acting). A is tempting but legal contract review has higher risk if AI errors go undetected and may require compliance review. C is viable but 'creative potential' is not a prioritisation criterion. D violates the principle of focused, manageable pilots.

Q15. What is the framework's position on the role of executive sponsorship in AI adoption?

- A) Executive sponsorship is helpful but not essential for success
- B) Executive sponsorship should be limited to budget approval without public visibility
- C) Active, visible executive sponsorship with public commitment is essential from Day 1 to signal seriousness and overcome resistance

D) Executive sponsorship should be delegated to the CTO or IT department

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct -- the framework begins with an executive announcement (not a memo) establishing public commitment, and identifies lack of executive sponsorship as one of the five primary failure modes. A underestimates its importance. B limits sponsorship to a behind-the-scenes role, which fails to overcome organisational resistance. D narrows sponsorship to IT, which signals that AI is a technology initiative rather than a business transformation.

Q16. Scenario: A professional services firm is entering Phase 3. Their most successful pilot was an AI-powered research assistant used by the consulting team. The pilot team of 4 consultants achieved a 40% reduction in research time. The Head of Consulting wants to limit expansion to one additional team 'to be safe'. What approach does the framework recommend?

- A) Follow the Head of Consulting's cautious approach to minimise risk
- B) Expand immediately to all consulting teams simultaneously, since the pilot proved the concept with clear metrics
- C) Wait for the next quarterly budget cycle before expanding
- D) Hire an external consultant to design the scaling plan

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because Phase 3 explicitly calls for rapid scaling of successful pilots to all relevant departments. With 40% research time reduction clearly measured, the use case is proven. Limiting expansion to one team wastes the momentum window. A is overly cautious and contradicts the framework's scaling velocity target. C introduces unnecessary delay. D adds cost and time without value when the pilot team already knows what works.

Q17. How does the framework recommend handling the objection 'we need more time to evaluate AI options'?

- A) Agree and extend the evaluation period to address concerns
- B) Counter that evaluation without experimentation is guesswork, and that hands-on use of tools during pilot execution produces better evaluation than months of reading vendor materials
- C) Ignore the objection and proceed without addressing it
- D) Commission an independent third-party evaluation to settle the debate

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct -- the framework explicitly states that 'a team that uses three AI tools for two weeks learns more than a committee that reads vendor whitepapers for six months.' The framework does not skip evaluation; it compresses it by making evaluation concurrent with hands-on pilot execution. A feeds the analysis paralysis the framework is designed to prevent. C alienates stakeholders whose buy-in matters. D adds delay without addressing the core issue.

Q18. Scenario: A bank is in Week 6 of Phase 2. One pilot focused on AI-assisted customer email responses has shown a 25% reduction in response time and improved customer satisfaction scores. However, the compliance team has not yet completed their review of the AI tool's data handling practices. What is the BEST course of action?

- A) Scale the pilot immediately to capture the competitive advantage
- B) Document the pilot results, continue the compliance review, and prepare the scaling plan so deployment can begin the day compliance approval is received
- C) Abandon the pilot because compliance approval should have been completed before the pilot began
- D) Switch to a different AI tool that does not require compliance review

Answer: B **Explanation:** B correctly balances the framework's speed imperative with the legitimate need for compliance approval in a regulated industry. The results are documented, the scaling plan is ready, and deployment starts immediately upon approval -- no time is wasted. A is reckless in a regulated industry and could create serious legal exposure. C is unnecessarily harsh; the framework recommends running security reviews in parallel, and a slight delay does not invalidate the pilot. D assumes another tool would not require the same review.

Q19. According to the framework's timeline comparison, when does an organisation using the 4-Phase approach achieve first measurable results?

- A) Week 2
- B) Week 6
- C) Week 10
- D) Month 12

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct -- the framework's timeline shows that Phase 2 concludes at Week 6 with results presentations containing quantified ROI from pilot projects. A is too early (Phase 1 is still in progress). C is Phase 3 scaling, which uses results already measured at Week 6. D is the traditional approach timeline, not the 4-Phase Framework.

Q20. Scenario: A CEO has just committed to the 4-Phase Framework. She has scheduled the leadership training for next week and department exploration sessions for the week after. However, her IT security team says they need at least three months to evaluate and approve AI tools before anyone in the company can use them. What should the CEO do to maintain the framework's timeline?

- A) Accept the three-month security timeline and delay the entire programme
- B) Override the security team and deploy AI tools without their approval
- C) Run the security review in parallel with Phase 1 activities, focusing the review on enterprise-grade AI tools that already hold SOC 2 and ISO 27001 certifications, and use only approved tools for Phase 2 pilots
- D) Limit AI adoption to tools that do not require security review, such as free consumer versions

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because the framework explicitly recommends running security reviews in parallel rather than sequentially. Enterprise AI tools from established vendors typically hold existing security certifications that can accelerate review. Phase 1 activities (training, exploration) can proceed while security evaluates tools for Phase 2. A creates the kind of delay that makes the framework ineffective. B is irresponsible and creates real risk. D introduces consumer-grade tools that may actually pose greater security risks than enterprise versions.

